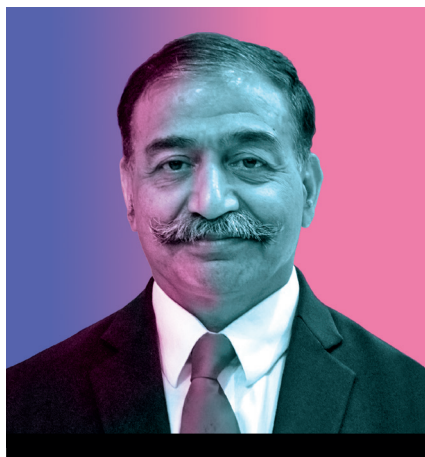
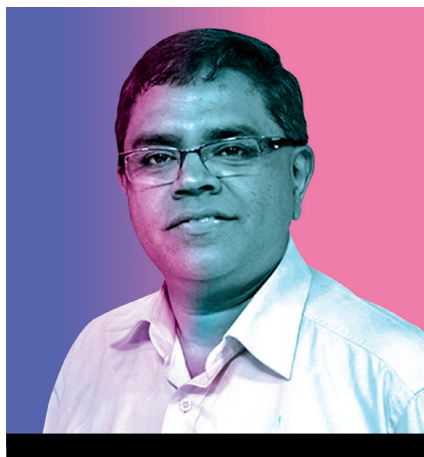




“The largest share of opportunities will be in applications... since that includes communications, health, education, and mining to intelligence, surveillance and reconnaissance”

**LT. GEN (RETD)
ANIL KUMAR BHATT
DIRECTOR GENERAL, ISPA**



“With SSLV of ISRO, Skyroot and AgniKul put together, we can potentially become the space lorries to haul all the baggage for the world. Start-ups can piggyback on ISRO’s success and take humans to the lower earth orbit”

**SATYANARAYANAN CHAKRAVARTHY
PROFESSOR, DEPARTMENT OF AEROSPACE
ENGINEERING, IIT MADRAS**

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vestors are taking more interest in the space sector, with CY2022 seeing funding of \$100 million.

“Most of the funding has been received in small payload launch vehicles, satellite-based services, and propulsion systems,” says Neha Singh, Co-founder & CEO of start-up data analytics firm Tracxn Technologies. “Factors making the sector attractive are favourable government policies, lower manufacturing and development costs and increasing demand for satellite-based data,” she adds.

One of the reasons behind the growing interest in such start-ups is the availability of a global marketplace for their products. “If you take Swiggy or Dunzo, the opportunity is India only, but if you look at spacetechnology, it’s global. India is among the few nations that have

been at the forefront of spacetechnology. Therefore, the government has realised the need to propel private space alongside ISRO to capture a larger share of this market,” says Vishesh Rajaram, Managing Partner at Speciale Invest, a VC fund.

A high return on investment and the fact that it is going to be one of the sunrise industries are compelling reasons to invest in spacetechnology, say experts. Ravinder Pal Singh, Partner at Kalaari Capital, shares an interesting insight. In the last decade, about \$27 billion was invested in the space sector globally. Today, the combined value of that investment is close to \$4 trillion. “The time has come for large investors to participate in the sector and encourage start-ups in India. From seed to Series-A, and—to a certain extent—Series-B has been taken

care of. But the real growth capital has to become easier. Large investors and industry must seriously start focussing on space because every use case—from consumer to an agro company to a manufacturing unit to an EV company—is going to benefit from the innovations happening in the space,” he says.

As the sector expands, how good is the possibility of India spawning entrepreneurs like SpaceX Founder Elon Musk? Goenka has some pointed advice for start-up founders. “To become a company like SpaceX, one cannot do what somebody else has already done. One has to be doing something that no one else has done before. And it is start-ups that are going to bring that innovation.” **BT**

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